

New Member Project 2026

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Overview

Your task is to create a circuit that monitors 16 temperature sensors, converts them into digital signals, processes them, and then outputs them over the I2C bus. By *November 1, 2026* you must deliver:

- A circuit schematic
- A flow chart for your circuit
- Working code
- A physical circuit
- A design document

Your group will be expected to present your final circuit/design at the end of the 8 week process, either on *Tuesday, November 3, 2026* or *Thursday, November 5, 2026*. You will also have the opportunity to elect to present your design on the week of *October 18, 2026*.

While some members of the group may focus more on hardware and others software, it is **expected** that **all** members of the group be knowledgeable about **both** the hardware and software.

Project Breakdown

Schematic

Groups will be expected to use the **student version of Altium Designer** to design a circuit which includes:

- 1 Arduino Nano
- 12V to 5V DCDC Converter
- Converts the temperature sensors input into an analog signal (signal conditioning)
- Multiplexer: CD74HC4067
- Blinking Red LED
- Implement all components according to
- Commit Altium Designer changes to git

Code

Groups will be expected to write C code for their arduinos. Your code is expected to

- Read the analog signal from each temperature sensor
- Convert the analog signal into a voltage using the onboard ADC (look this up if you don't know what it means!)
- Find the highest temperature of all 16 sensors

- Report that temperature via I2C
- Maintain a git repository for version control (including standard basic documentation such as a README.md - note that is is different from the design document.)
 - For a reference you may view the [official RFR firmware github](#)

FOR THE PURPOSES OF THE NEW MEMBER PROJECT AND PROCESS THE USE OF GENERATIVE AI AND CODING ASSISTANTS IS **NOT ALLOWED**

Using websites like stack overflow and geeks4geeks is encouraged, however, if you take a piece of code from an external source please leave a comment attributing the original source. Active use of version control is expected, including informative commit messages. For those who are unaware, see [conventional commits](#).

Altium

You will be expected to use Altium Designer to create a schematic and present your design. You must use Altium Designer Student Edition and will not be given RFR licenses until you are doing RFR work. You will use git for version control (and for us to monitor your progress.)

There are plenty of resources online on how to use

Design Document

A design document, or design doc, is a **written**, document that includes pictures, figures, calculations, and explanations of your engineering choices. You should be explaining why you choose a certain algorithm or filtering strategy over another (for example: ‘based on the provided parts and rules, it made the most sense to...’ or ‘because of the arduino nano has X characteristic, we choose Y algorithm’, etc.). The document should be uploaded in .pdf format as well as the original format (i.e. a .tex file if it’s written in L^AT_EX, or a .docx file if it’s written using word, .md files are also acceptable and the .md file alone is okay). You can view sample design documents [here](#) and [here](#).

Timelines

The new member project will be split into two phases: first there is *design*, and *assembly and integration*.

- The design phase will run from Tuesday September 21 till Sunday October 18. On October 18, groups will be expected to have their schematics completed, flow charts made, and an outline of code architecture uploaded to GitHub along with **completed design documents**.
- The assembly and manufacturing phase will run from Monday October 19 till Sunday November 1. On November 1, groups will be expect to have a functional physical circuit with working code, a written design document, and a tracked history of commits on GitHub.

Misc.

1. This project was specifically choosen because of its room for added complexity. A (non-exhaustive) list of ways to increase the complexity of the project include:
 - (a) Finding the all three of the lowest, highest, and average temperature
 - (b) Implementing a filtering algorithm to remove noise
 - (c) Reporting all 16 channel temperatures over I2C
 - (d) Min-maxxing time/space complexity
 - (e) Active Filtering + Amplification
 - (f) Utilizing a I2C Mux rather than an Analog MUX
 - (g) Achieve atleast an 1000Hz sampling rate

2. If there is an issue with any person in a group (not putting in work, unable to reach them, arguments, etc) it is the responsibility of the *group* to reach out to Vaanika and Jeevan. Based on the situation, we will determine what the next steps are.
3. Working on the new member project **does not** stop you from being able to take on other work. Note that the new member project is equally as important as any other work you may receive.
4. Throughout the course of the following 6 weeks electronics meetings will become shorter 30 – 45 minute seminars surrounding skills you will need to know in regards to the new member project. These include:
 - Microcontroller Basics
 - Sensor Input Conditioning
 - Version Control
 - Basic Electronic Tools

However, we expect that you will put in time outside of these meetings/seminars to learn on your own, as well as coming to the shop and ask questions.

5. Before you can work with any live electronics in the shop you **must** be REHS trained. Any member of any group who does not get REHS trained is unable to participate in the assembly phase.
6. Similarly, members must have signed the RFR Constitution, Waiver, and Code of Conduct before participating in the assembly phase.
7. During the assembly phase, groups **must** work on their circuit *inside the shop*. No group or group member is able to take any components of the circuit outside of the shop.
8. All group members are expected to be **respectful, kind, communicative, and responsible**. Members who are not following these traits may lead to removal from the new member process and the team overall.
9. Design presentations will happen on Tuesday, October 20 and Thursday, October 22. **It is optional to present your design** (meaning the meetings this week are optional), however, it is highly recommended in order to get final feedback on your system before moving into the assembly phase. Final presentations will happen on Tuesday, November 3 and Thursday, November 5 - **these are NOT optional**, every group must present.
10. As mentioned earlier, each group member is expected to understand **both** the hardware and software aspects of the project. They should be able to answer technical questions of moderate rigor.

⁰L^AT_EX code for this document can be found on github [here](#)